Red Wine Braised Short Ribs Dinner

Sunday dinner · 3 at the table · served 6:00 pm · revised after the 18 October 2026 cook (rated 10)

Menu

- **Red Wine Braised Short Ribs** — braised Saturday, reheated Sunday
- **Soft Polenta**
- **Butter-Glazed Carrots**
- **Parsley–Lemon Gremolata** — over the ribs
- **Arugula Salad**

Wine — 18 October: 2015 Clos Apalta, decanted at 5:00 pm; paired very well. Next time, choose from the cellar on the day.

Shopping list

Before you shop

- Ribs by Friday evening — they are salted at 8:00 pm.
- The braising wine is its own S$25–35 bottle — never the wine for the table.
- Check the polenta pack says 30–40 min.
- About 3 kg / 6½ lb of ice in the freezer by Saturday afternoon — two cooling baths.
- Not on the list: a 23 × 33 cm metal pan, a metal bowl, and the roasting pan or sheet pan for the ice.

Ingredient	Buy	Ribs	Polenta	Carrots	Gremolata	Salad
PROTEIN						
Beef short ribs, bone-in — English-cut, 5–6 cm / 2–2½ in thick, Angus; not flanken or galbi; not high-marble Wagyu	1.6 kg / 3½ lb	1.6 kg	—	—	—	—
PRODUCE						
Arugula, young	60 g / 2 oz	—	—	—	—	60 g
Carrots, medium	500 g / 1.1 lb	100 g	—	400 g	—	—
Celery	2 stalks	2 stalks	—	—	—	—
Flat-leaf parsley — not curly	1 small bunch	—	—	—	2 tbsp	—
Garlic	1 head	5 cloves	—	—	¼ clove	—
Lemon, unwaxed if available	1	—	—	—	½ tsp zest	—
Onion, yellow	1 large / 250 g	1	—	—	—	—
Thyme	3 sprigs	3 sprigs	—	—	—	—
PANTRY						
Anchovy fillets (pantry check)	2	2	—	—	—	—
Bay leaf (pantry check)	1	1	—	—	—	—
Black peppercorns (pantry check)	1 tsp	1 tsp	—	—	—	—
Polenta — traditional, pack time 30–40 min; not instant; not 45–60 min bramata	85 g / 3 oz	—	85 g	—	—	—
Tomato paste (pantry check)	2 tbsp / 30 g	2 tbsp	—	—	—	—
FRIDGE, DAIRY AND FREEZER						
Parmigiano-Reggiano	20 g / ¾ oz	—	20 g	—	—	—
Unsalted butter	55 g / 4 tbsp	15 g	20 g	20 g	—	—
Ice (freezer check)	≈3 kg / 6½ lb	≈3 kg	—	—	—	—
OILS AND LIQUIDS						
Beef stock — low-sodium or unsalted; not regular stock or bouillon	500 ml / 2 cups	500 ml	—	—	—	—
Braising wine — dry Chilean Cabernet or Carmenère, or Merlot-led Bordeaux, S$25–35; not jammy or oaky; not the drinking wine	1 bottle / 750 ml	750 ml	—	—	—	—
Extra-virgin olive oil (pantry check)	1 tbsp + ½ tsp	—	—	—	½ tsp	1 tbsp
Neutral oil (pantry check)	2 tbsp	2 tbsp	—	—	—	—
Sherry vinegar (pantry check)	2 tsp	≤1 tsp	—	—	—	1 tsp
SEASONING						
Black pepper (pantry check)	½ tsp	½ tsp	—	—	—	—
Diamond Crystal kosher salt (pantry check)	≈12 g + pinches	7 g	3 g	1.5 g	pinch	pinch

Timeline

1. The ribs set the pace on Sunday: they must reach 74°C / 165°F before they are served. The polenta and carrots wait for them, never the other way round.

2. Saturday's cooling is a safety step, for the ribs and the liquid each: 21°C / 70°F or below within 2 hours of leaving the oven, 5°C / 41°F or below within 6 hours. Be home until both read 21°C.

3. Taste the sauce with the wine before adding any vinegar.

Friday

Time	Do
8:00 pm	Salt the ribs all over with the 7 g; rack over a tray, uncovered, in the fridge. About 3 kg of ice into the freezer.

Saturday

Time	Do
1:30 pm	Ribs out; pat dry; pepper. Dice onion, carrot and celery to 1 cm; smash the garlic. 125 ml / ½ cup stock into a jug.
1:45 pm	Outdoor burner: cast-iron skillet with 1 tbsp oil, medium-high.
1:50 pm	Sear in two batches until every meat face is deep mahogany, 12–15 min a batch.
2:20 pm	Ribs out; pour off the fat; deglaze the skillet with the 125 ml stock. Oven to 160°C / 320°F. Indoors, side by side: build the base in the wide Le Creuset; boil the wine down by half in the sauté pan.
2:45 pm	Assemble: the remaining 375 ml stock, then boiling water to two-thirds up the ribs (note how much). Bring to a simmer, lid on.
2:50 pm	Into the oven.
5:05 pm	First tenderness check, then every 20 min. Usually done 5:20–6:20 pm (2½ h on 18 Oct).
When tender	Ribs out — start a timer.

Once the ribs are out on Saturday — start a timer

Timer	Do
0:00	Ribs into the metal pan, one layer, bone side up, 3–4 tbsp strained liquid over. Strain the rest of the liquid into a metal bowl. Ribs pan in the roasting pan (or on the sheet pan) with ice and water; liquid bowl in its own ice bath. Water no higher than the food. Uncovered; fresh ice every 20–30 min; stir the liquid every 10 min.
1:00	Probe the thickest rib and the liquid. Either above 40°C / 104°F: fresh ice, split the ribs into a second metal container, cling film on the ribs with bags of ice on top. (18 Oct: rib 29°C / 85°F.)
2:00	Both at 21°C / 70°F or below. Keep in the baths until below 10°C / 50°F, then refrigerate: ribs in a lidded glass or stainless container; liquid in its bowl under cling film, on a level shelf.
by 6:00	Rib centre and liquid both at 5°C / 41°F or below — check before bed.

Have to go out before 2:00? Only once both read 21°C or below — then into the fridge, loosely covered. Above 21°C at 2:00: reheat that part to 74°C / 165°F (the liquid to a boil), then cool again in more containers. Not at 5°C by 6:00: discard it.

Sunday — served 6:00 pm

Time	Do
3:30 pm	Lift the fat disc off the liquid; scrape the jelly off the ribs into the liquid. Ribs into the enamelled Lodge pot, one layer, bone side up.
4:00 pm	Oven to 150°C / 300°F.
4:05 pm	Melt the jelly in the sauté pan and measure it (about 900 ml on 18 Oct). 120 ml / ½ cup over the ribs; the rest stays covered on the lowest setting.
4:15 pm	Ribs, lid on, into the oven (65 min to 74°C on 18 Oct).
4:20–4:50 pm	Prep: carrots; parsley and zest; wash and spin the arugula; whisk the dressing; grate the Parmigiano; weigh the butter; fill the kettle.
4:30 pm	Boil the sauce hard until it coats a spoon, 15–30 min (20 min to 300 ml on 18 Oct). Then into the small saucepan, covered, lowest setting.
5:00 pm	Decant the wine. Probe the thickest rib, then every 10 min. At 74°C / 165°F: oven to 95°C / 200°F, door open 2 min, lid stays on. Polenta water and salt on to boil.
5:05 pm	Whisk in the polenta; 30–40 min (30 on 18 Oct), stirring every 5 min.
5:35–5:45 pm	Polenta tender: butter and Parmigiano in; lid on, lowest setting — holds 30 min.
5:40 pm	Plates into the oven.
5:42 pm	Sauce into the oven. Carrots on: boil 2 min, lid on 4 min, glaze 4–6 min.
5:48 pm	Finish the gremolata.
5:52–5:54 pm	Carrots off the heat at the bite.
5:54 pm	Sauce out: butter in off the heat; taste with the wine; vinegar only if needed; salt.
5:56 pm	Plate: polenta, rib, sauce, gremolata, carrots.
5:58 pm	Dress the salad.
6:00 pm	Serve.

If something is off

- **Ribs not at 74°C / 165°F by 5:30 pm** — keep them at 150°C / 300°F and probe every 10 min. The polenta stays on lowest and the carrots wait off the heat; serve when the ribs are there.
- **Sauce still thin at 5:00 pm** — keep boiling; it must be off the burner by 5:40 pm for the carrots.
- **Rib centre drops below 60°C / 140°F while holding** — back to 150°C / 300°F until it reads 74°C / 165°F again.

Write down on the day

Sat: wine reduced in ___ min · water added ___ ml	Cooling at 2:00: rib ___ °C · liquid ___ °C	Salt from the brine: low / right / high
Ribs held at 95°C: ___ min	Sauce held: ___ min · still coats a spoon?	Carrots: off the heat ___ min before plating · bite?

Red Wine Braised Short Ribs

Serves 3 · Friday 10 min · Saturday 1:30–2:50 pm active, 2½–3½ h in the oven, about 2 h cooling · Sunday about 25 min active · Oven 160°C / 320°F Saturday; 150°C / 300°F, then 95°C / 200°F Sunday

Short ribs braised a day ahead in reduced red wine, chilled, degreased and reheated until knife-tender but still on the bone, with a glossy sauce. Rated 10 on 18 October 2026; this version carries that day's pots and the separate cooling of ribs and liquid.

1.6 kg / 3½ lb	bone-in beef short ribs, English-cut single bones 5–6 cm / 2–2½ in thick
7 g (≈2½ tsp)	Diamond Crystal kosher salt
½ tsp	freshly ground black pepper
2 tbsp / 28 g	neutral oil, divided
1 large (250 g / 9 oz)	yellow onion, peeled, 1 cm dice
1 medium (100 g / 3½ oz)	carrot, peeled, 1 cm dice
2 stalks (100 g / 3½ oz)	celery, 1 cm dice
5 cloves	garlic, peeled and smashed
2	anchovy fillets
2 tbsp / 30 g	tomato paste
750 ml / 1 bottle	dry red for braising: Chilean Cabernet Sauvignon or Carmenère, or a Merlot-led Bordeaux
500 ml / 2 cups	low-sodium beef stock (125 ml / ½ cup for the skillet, the rest in the pot)
3 sprigs · 1 · 1 tsp	thyme · bay leaf · black peppercorns
1 tbsp / 15 g	cold unsalted butter, cubed
up to 1 tsp / 5 ml	sherry vinegar
≈3 kg / 6½ lb	ice, for Saturday's two cooling baths

Friday

1. Salt, 8:00 pm. Pat dry, salt every face and leave on a rack over a tray, uncovered, in the fridge. Put the ice in the freezer.

Saturday

2. Sear, 1:45 pm. Pat the ribs dry and season with the pepper. Heat 1 tbsp oil in a cast-iron skillet on the outdoor burner over medium-high. Sear in two batches, turning a face only when it releases, until every meat face is deep mahogany, 12–15 min a batch. Pour off the fat, deglaze the skillet with 125 ml / ½ cup stock, scraping, and keep the liquid. Heat the oven to 160°C / 320°F.

3. Base and wine, 2:20 pm. In the wide Le Creuset over medium, cook the onion, carrot and celery in 1 tbsp oil until the onion is translucent and golden at the edges, 8–10 min. Add the garlic and anchovy for 1 min, pressing the anchovy until it disappears, then the tomato paste, stirring, until brick red and just catching, 2–3 min. Meanwhile boil the wine in the sauté pan over high until halved to about 375 ml / 1½ cups, 12–20 min.

4. Assemble, 2:45 pm. Add the reduced wine and the skillet liquid and scrape the base clean. Fit the ribs in one layer, bone side up, tuck in the thyme, bay and peppercorns, and add the remaining 375 ml / 1½ cups stock; if the liquid is still below two-thirds up the ribs, top up with boiling water, 125 ml / ½ cup at a time, and note how much. Bring to a simmer, cover, and into the oven by 2:50 pm.

5. Braise, from 5:05 pm. Push a skewer into the thickest meat of two ribs: when it slides in and out with almost no resistance, they are done; if it meets springy push-back, give them 20 min more. Expect 2½–3½ h (2½ h on 18 October). Take them out at the first clear sign — Sunday's reheat softens them further.

6. Cool, straight away. Lift the ribs with tongs under the meat into the metal pan, one layer, bone side up, and spoon 3–4 tbsp of the strained liquid over. Strain the rest into a metal bowl. Set each in its own ice bath, uncovered, and follow the cooling timer on the timeline page. Not in the Le Creuset: cast iron holds heat.

Sunday

7. Degrease, 3:30 pm. Lift the fat disc off the liquid and discard it. Scrape the jelly off the ribs into the liquid and put the ribs in the enamelled Lodge pot in one layer, bone side up.

8. Reheat, 4:05 pm. With the oven at 150°C / 300°F, melt the jelly in the sauté pan over medium and measure it. Pour 120 ml / ½ cup over the ribs, cover, and into the oven at 4:15 pm; keep the rest covered on the lowest setting. From 5:00 pm probe the thickest rib every 10 min (65 min to 74°C on 18 October): at 74°C / 165°F, turn the oven to 95°C / 200°F, open the door for 2 min and leave the pot covered. They hold there for up to 60 min.

9. Reduce the sauce, 4:30 pm. Boil hard until it coats the back of a spoon and a finger drawn through it leaves a clean line, 15–30 min (about 250–300 ml / 1–1¼ cups; 20 min on 18 October). Pour into the small saucepan, cover and keep on the lowest setting; move it to the oven at 5:42 pm.

10. Finish, 5:54 pm. Off the heat, whisk in the cold butter until glossy. Taste the sauce with a sip of the wine; add vinegar ¼ tsp at a time only if it tastes heavy, and stop while the wine still tastes as full after a bite. Salt last, by the pinch.

11. Plate, 5:56 pm. A rib on each spoonful of polenta, about 75 ml / ⅓ cup sauce over, gremolata on top. The rest of the sauce to the table.

Soft Polenta

Serves 3 · about 60 min including the hold · 10 min active

Soft, spoonable polenta finished with butter and Parmigiano, there to carry the sauce — half February's batch.

600 ml / 2½ cups	water, plus hot water from the kettle to loosen
3 g (≈1 tsp)	Diamond Crystal kosher salt
85 g / 3 oz (½ cup)	traditional polenta (30–40 min pack time)
20 g / 1½ tbsp	unsalted butter
20 g / ¾ oz	Parmigiano-Reggiano, finely grated

1. Boil, 5:00 pm. Bring the water and salt to a boil in a small heavy saucepan, 16–18 cm.

2. Cook, 5:05 pm. Pour in the polenta in a thin stream, whisking until it thickens, about 2 min. Cook at the lowest heat that keeps an occasional bubble, lid ajar, stirring every 5 min and scraping the corners, until a few grains pressed against the roof of your mouth have no gritty centre, 30–40 min (30 on 18 October). Loosen with 2 tbsp hot water whenever it is stiffer than soft porridge.

3. Finish and hold, 5:35–5:45 pm. Stir in the butter and Parmigiano; salt to taste. Cover and keep on the lowest setting, stirring every 5 min, for up to 30 min. At plating, whisk in hot water a tablespoon at a time until a spoonful slumps slowly.

Butter-Glazed Carrots

Serves 3 · 25 min · 20 min active

Carrots glazed in butter and their own sugar — no sugar added — and taken off while the centre still has bite.

400 g / 14 oz	carrots, peeled, cut into 6 × 1 cm / 2½ × ½ in batons
20 g / 1½ tbsp	unsalted butter
120 ml / ½ cup	water
1.5 g (≈½ tsp)	Diamond Crystal kosher salt

1. Cook, 5:42 pm. Put everything in the rinsed sauté pan in one layer and bring to a boil over high, about 2 min. Cover and cook over medium for 4 min.

2. Glaze. Uncover, turn the heat to high and shake the pan until the water has gone and the butter coats the carrots in a glossy film, 4–6 min; add 1 tbsp water if the pan dries first. Take off the heat when a knife slides through the outside easily but meets clear resistance at the centre, 5:52–5:54 pm. They soften a little more as they wait — they go on the plates last, up to 8 min later.

Parsley–Lemon Gremolata

Serves 3 · 10 min

Parsley, lemon zest and a trace of garlic over the ribs — zest only, so it lifts the plate without sharpening the wine.

2 tbsp (≈8 g leaves)	flat-leaf parsley, finely chopped
½ tsp	lemon zest, yellow only
¼ small clove	garlic, grated on a microplane
½ tsp / 2 g	extra-virgin olive oil
pinch	Diamond Crystal kosher salt

1. Prep, 4:20–4:50 pm. Wash and dry the parsley thoroughly, chop it finely and mix with the zest; cover and refrigerate.

2. Finish, 5:48 pm. Grate in the garlic, add the oil and salt, and mix. About 1 tsp on each rib. Leftovers go in the fridge.

Arugula Salad

Serves 3 · 10 min

Peppery arugula in a light sherry dressing — the crisp reset between bites.

60 g / 2 oz	young arugula
1 tbsp / 13 g	extra-virgin olive oil
1 tsp / 5 ml	sherry vinegar
pinch	Diamond Crystal kosher salt

1. Prep, 4:20–4:50 pm. Wash and spin the arugula completely dry; refrigerate in a towel-lined bowl. Whisk the oil, vinegar and salt in the salad bowl.

2. Dress, 5:58 pm. Whisk again, add the leaves and toss by hand until just coated. Serve straight away.